



NVMe SSDs

Blazing speeds, refined designs

The NVMe SSD market in 2024 continues to evolve, offering higher speeds and better efficiency at increasingly competitive price points. While PCIe Gen 5 SSDs showcase cutting-edge performance, PCIe Gen 4 SSDs remain the sweet spot for most users, balancing affordability with excellent performance. In fact, we barely saw any NVMe SSDs launch with PCIe 5.0 in India.

With the PCIe Gen 5.0 controllers yet to mature to the extent that widescale adoption becomes feasible, customers have been sticking to PCIe Gen 4.0 SSDs. What we did see, however, was more value-added services and features getting bundled with storage drives.

It's either that or co-branded offerings in collaboration with console manufacturers or even entertainment franchises. Also, PCIe Gen 4.0 controllers became much more cost-effective, allowing for even cheaper SSDs to offer higher transfer speeds.

The market also saw significant advancements in power efficiency and thermal management, making these drives suitable for a wider range of applications, including compact devices and gaming consoles.

WD and Kingston have emerged as the leaders this year, with their standout offerings setting new benchmarks for performance and value.

Hopefully, 2025 will see PCIe Gen 5.0 controllers become cheaper, more power-efficient, and have better thermal profiles. Here are the winners of the Zero1 Awards in the NVMe SSD category for 2024.



Kingston NV3
Price: ₹10,999 (2 TB)



WD Black SN850P
Price: ₹21,999 (2 TB)

Winner: WD Black SN850P

The WD SN850P earns the Zero1 Award this year for its stellar performance. Built on the PCIe Gen 4 platform, this SSD delivers sequential read speeds of up to 7,300 MBps and write speeds of up to 6,600 MBps. These speeds make it a powerhouse for demanding workloads, from gaming to heavy content creation. Designed to be used with the Sony PlayStation 5, the WD Black SN850P is a simple drop-in accessory for PS5 owners.

The SN850P is also equipped with robust thermal management, featuring a heatsink designed to maintain consistent performance even under sustained loads.

While its power consumption and price place it firmly in the high-end segment, its superior performance makes it the go-to choice for users seeking the very best in NVMe technology.

Runner-Up and Best Buy: Kingston NV3

The Kingston NV3 claims both the runner-up position and wins the Best Buy Award for its excellent balance of performance and affordability. Featuring sequential read speeds of up to 6,000 MBps and write speeds of up to 5,000 MBps, the NV3 is well-suited for everyday use, gaming, and even light productivity tasks.

Its price-to-performance ratio is unmatched, making it an ideal choice for budget-conscious users. While it lacks the advanced thermal management of higher-end models, the NV3 performs reliably in typical workloads.

With aggressive pricing and dependable performance, the Kingston NV3 sets a new standard for value in the NVMe SSD market.

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